

# Model Dependence of PDG Comparison Values:

How Empirical Values Arise, Where Theory and Irrational Factors Enter, and What  
This Means for FFGFT Residuals

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## Status markers

- [K]** *Confirmed* — derived from  $\xi$ , numerically verified.
- [B]** *Proved* — algebraically established.
- [S]** *Speculative* — open.
- [Q]** *Source* — corpus-external primary source, verified here.

## Abstract

FFGFT predictions are compared against PDG and CODATA values. This document examines how those comparison values actually arise: which raw observable underlies each, which theory (QED, Standard Model) enters the extraction, and where irrational numbers already appear in the extraction formulae themselves.

Main findings: (1)  $m_e$  and  $m_\mu/m_e$  are the least model-dependent anchors, but  $m_\mu/m_e$  is QED-dependent and derives from a 27-year-old muonium HFS measurement whose theory uncertainty CODATA underestimates by a factor of 5–10 (Eides 2026). (2)  $\alpha$  carries an unresolved  $5\sigma$  tension between the two best recoil measurements. (3)  $v = 246$  GeV is never measured; it is the SM definition  $v \equiv (\sqrt{2} G_F)^{-1/2}$ . (4)  $G_F$  carries a theory correction  $\Delta q = -0.44\%$  with a  $4.7\sigma$  hadronic tension. (5)  $m_\tau$  has two measurement methods differing by 0.18 MeV; FFGFT lies  $0.4\sigma$  from the PDG average. (6) The magnitude of all theory uncertainties ( $10^{-7}$

to  $10^{-10}$ ) does not explain the  $\sim 1\%$  residual in  $(m_\mu/m_e)^2$  — it remains physical. (7) Errors accumulate along the derivation chain; every prediction requires its full provenance path. All 21 primary sources were verified on 5 September 2026.

## 1 The question

The corpus compares FFGFT predictions with PDG values and finds residuals at the sub-percent to percent level. Are PDG values theory-neutral, or do they themselves depend on the Standard Model — such that part of the residual arises on the extraction side rather than the FFGFT side?

The FFGFT foundational statement: only ratios free of irrational numbers are exact; SI absolute values are structurally approximate (Docs. 241, 085). If PDG values themselves contain irrational factors in their extraction, the same limitation applies to the comparison side.

## 2 How empirical values arise

No PDG or CODATA value is a raw measurement. Each passes through the same chain:

raw observable  $\rightarrow$  theory formula  $\rightarrow$  extracted parameter  $\rightarrow$  CODATA adjustment  $\rightarrow$  PDG value

### The CODATA adjustment

CODATA publishes recommended values every four years, produced by a joint least-squares adjustment over roughly 300 input data linked by theory relations (QED, Rydberg formula, kinematics). The values are therefore *correlated*: a change in one input shifts all dependent values. Where theory uncertainties enter, they are partly treated as adjustment parameters ( $\delta_{th}$  in the observational equations) rather than as errors — this is the Eides finding for muonium HFS [Q].

### Electron mass $m_e$

**Raw observable:** cyclotron frequency of a hydrogen-like ion ( $^{12}\text{C}^{5+}$ ,  $^{28}\text{Si}^{13+}$ ,  $^{20}\text{Ne}^{9+}$ ) in a Penning trap, and the Larmor precession frequency of the bound electron. The ratio is a pure number.

**Theory formula:** bound  $g$ -factor from QED bound-state theory. From the frequency ratio and  $g_{\text{bound}}$  follows  $m_e/m_{\text{ion}}$ ; with the ion mass in u follows  $m_e$  in u; conversion to MeV via  $u \rightarrow \text{kg} \rightarrow \text{MeV}$ .

**Theory dependence:** QED for  $g_{\text{bound}}$ , small and well controlled. Current: Heiße et al. (2023) at 0.1 ppb [Q].

### Muon-electron mass ratio $m_\mu/m_e$

**Raw observable:** ground-state hyperfine splitting of muonium — a microwave resonance at 4.463 GHz — and the Zeeman splitting in a magnetic field.

**Theory formula:**  $\Delta\nu_{\text{HFS}} = \nu_F [1 + \text{corrections}]$  with the Fermi frequency

$$\nu_F = \frac{16}{3} \alpha^2 c R_\infty \frac{m_e}{m_\mu} \left( \frac{m_r}{m_e} \right)^3. \quad (1)$$

Corrections: QED to  $O(\alpha^3)$ , recoil in  $m_e/m_\mu$ , weak  $Z$  exchange, hadronic vacuum polarisation.

**Theory dependence:** high. Sole precision measurement: LAMPF 1999 (Liu et al.). Eides (2026) shows that CODATA lists the measured value 4 463 302 776(51) Hz as the theoretical value; the actual theory uncertainty is 271–515 Hz **[Q]**.

**For FFGFT:**  $\nu_F \propto \alpha^2$ . The anchor  $m_\mu/m_e$  implicitly contains  $\alpha$ . Anchor and  $\alpha$  are not independent.

### Fine-structure constant $\alpha$

Two routes that disagree at  $5\sigma$  **[Q]**:

- **Atom recoil:**  $\alpha^2 = 2R_\infty (h/m_{\text{atom}})(m_{\text{atom}}/m_e)/c$ . Rb (Morel et al. 2020):  $\alpha^{-1} = 137.035\,999\,206(11)$ . Cs (Parker et al. 2018):  $137.035\,999\,046(27)$ . Difference  $1.6 \times 10^{-7}$ ,  $> 5\sigma$ .
- **Electron  $g - 2$ :**  $a_e$  at  $10^{-13}$  (Fan et al. 2023) plus 5-loop QED (12 672 diagrams, Aoyama et al.). Gives  $\alpha^{-1} = 137.035\,999\,166(15)$  — between Rb and Cs.

The CODATA value  $137.035\,999\,177(21)$  is an average covering none of the measurements. FFGFT:  $\alpha^{-1} = 3700/27 = 137.037\,037\dots$  (Doc. 338, R101), deviation 7.6 ppm — 100× larger than the Rb/Cs tension.

### Tau mass $m_\tau$ — two methods

| Method                  | Experiment    | Value (MeV)                          | Theory assumption  |
|-------------------------|---------------|--------------------------------------|--------------------|
| Threshold scan          | BESIII 2014   | $1776.91 \pm 0.12^{+0.10}_{-0.13}$   | QED cross-section  |
| Pseudomass              | Belle II 2023 | $1777.09 \pm 0.08 \pm 0.11$          | $m_{\nu_\tau} = 0$ |
| <b>PDG average 2024</b> | —             | <b><math>1776.93 \pm 0.09</math></b> | —                  |

**Threshold scan:**  $\sigma(e^+e^- \rightarrow \tau^+\tau^-)$  versus beam energy near  $2m_\tau \approx 3.55$  GeV;  $m_\tau$  as fit parameter of the QED threshold curve. **Pseudomass:** at 10.6 GeV, the kinematic edge of the invariant mass in  $\tau \rightarrow 3\pi\nu_\tau$  assumes  $m_{\nu_\tau} = 0$ .

**For FFGFT:**  $m_\tau = 1776.97$  MeV (pred) lies  $0.04$  MeV =  $0.4\sigma$  from the PDG average. The methods differ by  $0.18$  MeV. The falsification test is undecided; Belle II with  $> 1$  ab $^{-1}$  should reach  $\sigma < 0.05$  MeV.

### Fermi constant $G_F$ and vacuum expectation value $\nu$

**Raw observable for  $G_F$ :** muon decay time distribution (MuLan,  $10^{12}$  decays),  $\tau_\mu = 2.196\,980\,3(22)$   $\mu\text{s}$  **[Q]**.

**Theory formula** (Eberhart et al. 2026 **[Q]**):

$$\tau_\mu^{-1} = \frac{G_F^2 m_\mu^5}{192\pi^3} (1 + \Delta q), \quad \Delta q = (-4\,384\,678 \pm 34) \times 10^{-9} \approx -0.44\%. \quad (2)$$

$\Delta q$  contains QED to  $O(\alpha^3)$ , hadronic vacuum polarisation, electron-mass effects. Purely electroweak corrections are absorbed into  $G_F$  by definition (Sirlin 1980). The hadronic component carries a  $4.7\sigma$  tension (CMD-3 vs. older data).

**Raw observable for  $\nu$ :** none.  $\nu \equiv (\sqrt{2}G_F)^{-1/2} = 246.22$  GeV follows from  $M_W = g\nu/2$  and  $G_F/\sqrt{2} = g^2/(8M_W^2)$ .  $\nu$  **exists only within the Standard Model**. Its numerical value is the muon lifetime in SM clothing.

**For FFGFT:** Doc. 006/R104 gives  $\nu = 248.3$  GeV (without  $K_{\text{frak}}$ ) or  $245.6$  GeV (with  $K_{\text{frak}} = 74/75$ ). Comparison with  $246.22$  GeV is a comparison of *FFGFT structure against SM definition*, not against an observable. Only  $\tau_\mu$  and  $m_\mu$  are measured.

## Gravitational constant $G$

Torsion balance (Li et al. 2018, 11.6 ppm) or atom interferometry (Rosi et al. 2014, 150 ppm). Theory: Newton. The only model-free value, but the least precise: CODATA  $6.67430(15) \times 10^{-11}$ , 22 ppm **[Q]**.

## Neutrino mass-squared differences

Event rates versus  $L/E$ , three-flavour fit (NuFIT 6.0 **[Q]**).  $\Delta m_{31}^2$  depends on whether SK atmospheric data are included: ratio 33.7 (with) vs. 33.9 (without). FFGFT  $360/11 = 32.73$ ; measurement uncertainty 1–3 %  $\approx$  FFGFT residual. Not discriminating.

## Overview

| Quantity           | Raw observable       | Theory in extraction               | Convention                        |
|--------------------|----------------------|------------------------------------|-----------------------------------|
| $m_e$              | frequency ratio      | QED ( $g_{\text{bound}}$ )         | —                                 |
| $m_\mu/m_e$        | HFS frequency        | QED, weak, hadr.                   | —                                 |
| $\alpha$ (Rb/Cs)   | interferometer phase | $R_\infty$ (QED)                   | —                                 |
| $\alpha$ ( $g-2$ ) | frequency ratio      | 5-loop QED                         | —                                 |
| $m_\tau$           | rates vs. $E$ / edge | QED threshold / $m_{\nu_\tau} = 0$ | beam calibration                  |
| $G_F$              | decay times          | Fermi + QED + hadr.                | Sirlin absorption                 |
| $\nu$              | —                    | —                                  | $\nu \equiv (\sqrt{2}G_F)^{-1/2}$ |
| $G$                | angle / acceleration | Newton                             | —                                 |
| $\Delta m^2$       | rates vs. $L/E$      | 3-flavour                          | with/without SK-atm               |

No value is theory-free. For FFGFT this means: comparison with PDG values is comparison with "QED + convention", not with raw observations.

## 3 Irrational factors in the extraction formulae

The FFGFT foundational statement — ratios of rationals are exact, SI absolute values carry the approximation of the projection  $S_m^1 \rightarrow \mathbb{R}_t$  (Docs. 306, 333) — applies to the SM extraction formulae themselves:

| Quantity          | Formula                                      | Irrational factor                                 |
|-------------------|----------------------------------------------|---------------------------------------------------|
| $G_F$             | $\tau_\mu^{-1} = G_F^2 m_\mu^5 / (192\pi^3)$ | $\pi^3$                                           |
| $\nu$             | $\nu = (\sqrt{2} G_F)^{-1/2}$                | $\sqrt{2}$                                        |
| $\alpha$ (recoil) | $\alpha^2 = 2R_\infty h / (mc)$              | $R_\infty \propto \alpha^2$ : implicitly circular |
| HFS               | $\nu_F \propto \alpha^2$                     | $\alpha^2$                                        |
| $\Delta q$        | expansion in $\alpha/\pi$                    | $\pi$ in every term                               |

" $G_F$  measured" means:  $\tau_\mu$  measured, divided by  $192\pi^3$ , square root taken. " $\nu$  measured" additionally means: divided by  $\sqrt{2}$ , square root again. The irrational factors come from the SM formulation (phase-space integral, Higgs normalisation), not from measurement. The only convention-free comparison would be at the level of  $\tau_\mu = 2.196\,980\,3\,\mu\text{s}$  — which FFGFT would have to predict directly **[S]**.

## 4 The residual in $(m_\mu/m_e)^2$ : exact computation

FFGFT bare (Doc. 338):  $(m_\mu/m_e)^2 = 43200$  exactly, an integer,  $= |GF(9)^*|^2 \cdot 5^2 \cdot |GF(27)|$ . With CODATA 2022 in exact rational arithmetic:

$$(m_\mu/m_e)_{\text{PDG}}^2 = 42753.12 \quad (3)$$

$$\text{residual} = 446.88 \quad (1.045 \%) \quad (4)$$

$$\sigma_{\text{rel}}((m_\mu/m_e)^2) = 4.35 \times 10^{-8} \Rightarrow \text{residual} = 240\,000 \sigma. \quad (5)$$

Possible error sources, computed:

- CODATA uncertainty:  $\pm 0.002$  — factor  $2 \times 10^5$  too small.
- Eides correction to HFS theory uncertainty (515 instead of 51 Hz):  $\pm 0.010$  — residual remains  $45\,000 \sigma$ .
- Choice of  $\alpha$  in the HFS anchor (FFGFT  $3700/27$  instead of CODATA): shifts  $(m_\mu/m_e)^2$  by  $-1.3$  — factor 500 too small.
- To reach 43200,  $m_\mu$  would need to be 551 keV higher (measurement error 2.3 eV), or  $m_e$  2.65 keV lower (error 0.15 meV), or the HFS 23 MHz lower (error 51 Hz).

**Conclusion [B]:** No measurement error explains the residual. It is physical and belongs to the theory: fractal-recursive correction (Docs. 295, 146, 338) and projection approximation (Docs. 306, 333). In the square, without square root:  $43200 \cdot (1 - 77.6 \xi) = 42753$ ;  $K_{\text{frak}} = 1 - 100\xi$  over-corrects by  $22.4 \xi$ . Which power of  $K_{\text{frak}}$  acts on the quadratic identity is not fixed in the corpus [S].

### Rational or irrational: where the comparison is clean

The discussion above compared three Galois identities against PDG values. Not all comparisons are equally clean:

| Comparison                                | Galois value    | Type               | Residual    |
|-------------------------------------------|-----------------|--------------------|-------------|
| $(m_\mu/m_e)^2$ vs. 43200                 | 43200 (integer) | rational           | $-1.034 \%$ |
| $m_\mu/m_e$ vs. $\sqrt{43200}$            | $120\sqrt{3}$   | <b>irrational!</b> | $-0.519 \%$ |
| $m_e \cdot m_\mu$ vs. 54 MeV <sup>2</sup> | 54 (integer)    | rational           | $-0.016 \%$ |

The linear comparison  $m_\mu/m_e$  vs.  $\sqrt{43200} = 120\sqrt{3}$  is *not a clean rational comparison*:  $\sqrt{43200}$  is irrational, and the  $-0.52 \%$  residual is not an independent physical finding. It equals exactly half the quadratic residual ( $-1.034 \%/2 \approx -0.517 \%$ ), because taking the square root approximately halves the deviation. Nothing new becomes visible.

Only two comparisons are algebraically clean:

- **Square:**  $(m_\mu/m_e)^2 = 43200$  — both sides rational, residual  $-1.034 \%$  physical.
- **Product:**  $m_e \cdot m_\mu = 54 \text{ MeV}^2$  — both sides rational, residual  $-0.016 \%$  [K] (Doc. 338; algebraic origin:  $|GF(3)^*| \cdot |GF(27)| = 2 \cdot 27 = 54$ ).

The product  $m_e \cdot m_\mu = 54 \text{ MeV}^2$  is the algebraically cleanest Galois identity with the smallest rational residual ( $-0.016 \%$ ). The absolute deviation is  $-0.0087 \text{ MeV}^2$  ( $-7400 \sigma$ ) — also physical, but 65 times smaller than the quadratic residual.

**Bookkeeping rule:** Galois identities should be compared only in their natural algebraic form — where no irrational numbers appear. For  $(m_\mu/m_e)^2 = 43200$  that is the square comparison; for  $m_e \cdot m_\mu$  the product. The linear comparison  $m_\mu/m_e$  vs.  $\sqrt{43200}$

should be avoided because it introduces an irrational intermediate (verification script: `pruef_351_rationale_vergleiche.py`).

The residual of the product comparison lies at order  $\xi$  itself:

| Quantity                  | Residual in units of $\xi$ | Interpretation                             |
|---------------------------|----------------------------|--------------------------------------------|
| $m_e \cdot m_\mu$ VS. 54  | $-1.21 \cdot \xi$          | order $\xi$ : SI projection <b>[K]</b>     |
| $(m_\mu/m_e)^2$ VS. 43200 | $-77.6 \cdot \xi$          | higher order: fractal-recursive <b>[K]</b> |

The SI projection  $S_m^1 \rightarrow \mathbb{R}_t$  (Docs. 085, 306, 333) structurally produces errors of order  $\xi$ . The product residual  $-0.016\% \approx 1.2 \cdot \xi$  lies precisely in this range and is therefore structurally explainable as an SI transition approximation **[K]**. The quadratic residual  $-1.034\% \approx 78 \cdot \xi$  lies in higher order and is explained by the fractal-recursive correction (Docs. 295, 146, 338).

**Result:** The Galois identity  $m_e \cdot m_\mu = 54 \text{ MeV}^2$  is the only currently known identity whose residual lies at order  $\xi$  — the structurally expected SI projection error. The residual is therefore not unexplained; it corresponds to the approximation of the SI transition.

### Constitutional description (after Stefaan Vossen, 5 Sept. 2026)

The following four-layer formulation summarises the epistemic status of the FFGFT comparisons:

| Layer                      | Status                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                        |
|----------------------------|-------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| <b>Layer-1</b>             | Exact within rational arithmetic: $(m_\mu/m_e)^2 = 43200$ and $m_e \cdot m_\mu = 54 \text{ MeV}^2$ are integer Galois identities without approximation <b>[B]</b> .                                                                                                                                                           |
| <b>Layer-2</b>             | One empirical dimensional anchor: $m_\mu = 105.66 \text{ MeV}$ (PDG). All absolute predictions follow from it <b>[K]</b> .                                                                                                                                                                                                    |
| <b>Residual</b>            | Empirical discrepancy with a structural explanation of approximately the correct order: $(m_\mu/m_e)^2$ deviates by $\approx 78 \cdot \xi$ from the PDG value (fractal-recursive correction, Doc. 295); $m_e \cdot m_\mu$ deviates by $\approx 1.2 \cdot \xi$ (SI projection approximation, Docs. 085, 306, 333) <b>[K]</b> . |
| <b>Quantitative bridge</b> | The forward derivation of the exact residual from the $S_m^1 \rightarrow \mathbb{R}_t$ non-isomorphism is not in the corpus. <b>Open [S]</b> .                                                                                                                                                                                |

The open [S] is not a gap in the pejorative sense but a precisely constituted limit: the theory states explicitly where its formal construction stops.

## 5 Error accumulation along the derivation chain

Each step carries a small residual (recursion  $\sim 100\xi$ , projection  $\sim \xi$ , extraction theory  $10^{-7}$ – $10^{-10}$ ). Already at  $m_\mu$ , the first step after the anchor  $m_e$ :

| Route $m_e \rightarrow m_\mu$                                          | Residual |
|------------------------------------------------------------------------|----------|
| Galois bare: $m_\mu = \sqrt{43200} m_e$                                | +0.52 %  |
| with $\sqrt{K_{\text{frak}}}$ : $m_\mu = \sqrt{43200 \cdot 74/75} m_e$ | −0.15 %  |
| via $\alpha$ : $E_0 = \sqrt{\alpha/\xi}$ , $m_\mu = E_0^2/m_e$         | +1.37 %  |

At  $m_\tau$  (second step),  $\nu$  (third, via  $\xi^{3/2}$ ), each derivation accumulates further. To decide where a residual sits, convergence of empirical values onto the algebraic ones would have to be established — it is not:  $m_\mu/m_e$  (1999),  $\alpha$  ( $5\sigma$  tension),  $\Delta m_{\text{atm}}^2$  ( $2.4\sigma$  shift in 2024),  $\nu$  (not measured).

**Bookkeeping:** For every reported prediction, state: (1) the anchor, (2) the number of derivation steps, (3) corrections applied and where, (4) the comparison value with its extraction method. "FFGFT predicts  $m_\mu$  to 0.5 %" is incomplete; complete: "From  $m_e$  (PDG), in one step via the Galois identity, without  $K_{\text{frak}}$ ,  $m_\mu$  follows with +0.52 % against the 1999 muonium HFS value."

## 6 Consequences for the corpus

**No numerical value in the corpus changes.** What changes:

1.  **$\nu$  is neither anchor nor observable.** Docs. 006, 319, R104: " $\nu = 246$  GeV (measured)"  $\rightarrow$  " $\nu = 246$  GeV (SM definition from  $G_F$ )". Register R112.
2.  **$m_\mu/m_e$  is QED-dependent.** "model-independent"  $\rightarrow$  "least model-dependent available value";  $\nu_F \propto \alpha^2$ . Register R113.
3.  **$\alpha$  has no unique measured value below 1 ppb.** Cite the comparison value as CODATA average with Rb/Cs tension.
4.  **$m_\tau$ :** two methods, PDG average 1776.93(9), FFGFT  $0.4\sigma$  — open.
5. **New open item [S]:**  $\tau_\mu$  directly from FFGFT, without detour via  $G_F$  and  $\nu$  — the only convention-free test of the weak sector.

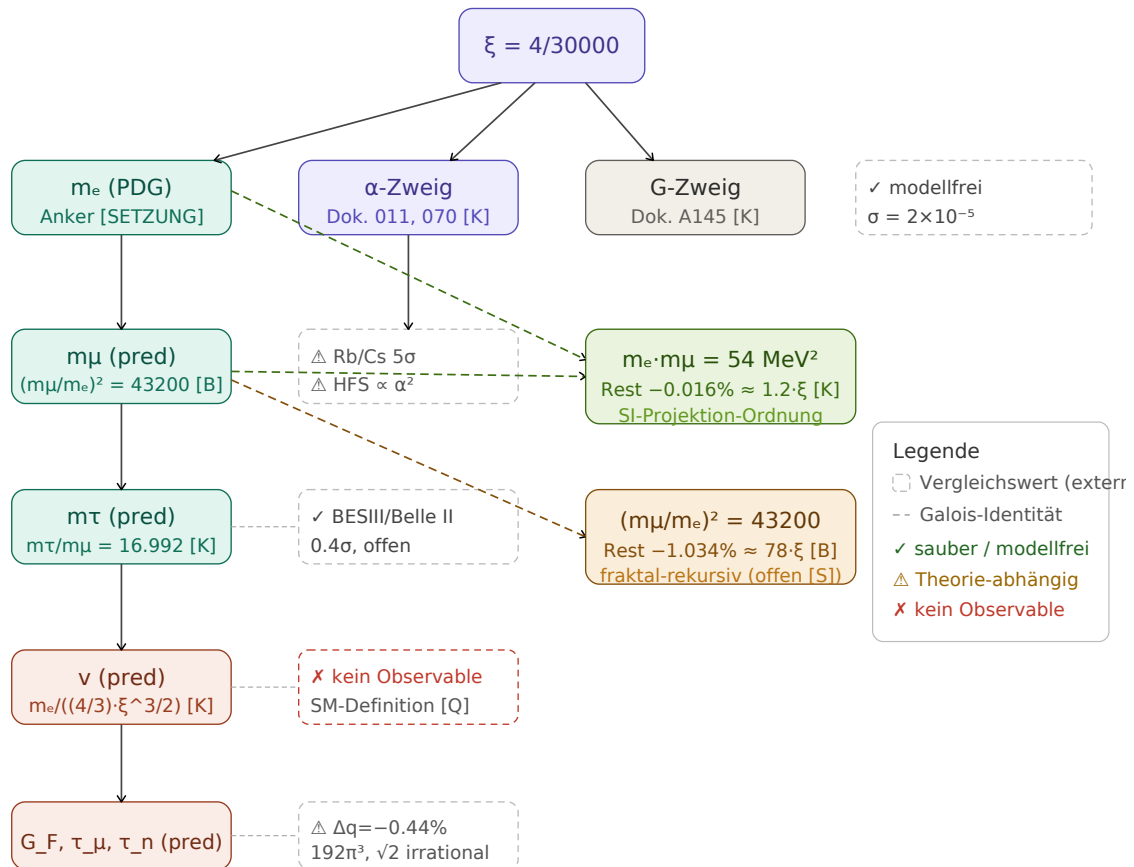
## Sources

All sources verified on 5 September 2026 against INSPIRE, APS, Nature, arXiv, or PubMed. Numerical values computed in exact rational arithmetic against CODATA 2022.



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Derivation chains: from  $\xi$  to comparison values. Dashed boxes = external comparison values; dashed arrows = Galois identities.

## 1 Affected derivation chains

Which FFGFT chain depends on which comparison value, and what each finding changes.

| Finding                             | Affected<br>ments    | docu-<br>rection | cor- | Wording correction                                                        |
|-------------------------------------|----------------------|------------------|------|---------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| $\nu$ is SM definition (R112)       | Docs. 006, 319, R104 | none             |      | " $\nu = 246$ GeV (measured)" $\rightarrow$ "(SM definition from $G_F$ )" |
| $G_F: \Delta q, 192\pi^3, \sqrt{2}$ | Docs. 006, R104, 319 | none             |      | state $\Delta q = -0.44\%$ ; clarify with/without $\Delta q$              |
| $m_\mu/m_e$ QED-dependent (R113)    | Docs. 338, 317, 011  | none             |      | "model-independent" $\rightarrow$ "least model-dependent"                 |
| $\alpha$ Rb/Cs $5\sigma$            | Docs. 011, 070, 338  | none             |      | cite CODATA average with tension                                          |
| $m_\tau$ two methods                | Docs. 317, 006       | none             |      | cite BESIII + Belle II; PDG average 1776.93(9)                            |
| Neutrinos $\Delta m^2$              | Docs. 339, 340       | none             |      | freeze NuFIT configuration                                                |
| $G$                                 | Doc. A145            | none             |      | —                                                                         |
| <b>Total</b>                        |                      | <b>none</b>      |      | wording clarifications                                                    |

The residual  $(m_\mu/m_e)^2 = 43200$  vs. 42753.12 (difference 446.9) is  $240\,000\sigma$  of the measurement uncertainty — physical (R113). No numerical value in the corpus changes.